

100 Advanced C1–C2 English Activities

Grounded in Strunk & White's *The Elements of Style* | Complete Master Framework

Module 1: Elementary Rules of Punctuation & Structural Mechanics

Activity 1.1: Oxford Comma Precision in Legal Contracts	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Punctuation clarity in series (<i>Punctuation Repair</i>)
Objective:	Apply the serial (Oxford) comma to eliminate ambiguity in multi-item legal lists.
Instructions:	Insert serial commas where necessary to ensure each party's liability is distinct.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The indemnity policy covers the directors, senior executive officers and regional managers.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The indemnity policy covers the directors, senior executive officers, and regional managers.'</i>
Activity 1.2: Parenthetical Enclosure with Paired Commas	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Parenthetical punctuation control (<i>Parenthetical Formatting</i>)
Objective:	Set off enclosed parenthetical expressions with paired commas without breaking sentence syntax.
Instructions:	Identify and punctuate the parenthetical clause in an executive announcement.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The CEO who recently chaired the European summit announced a major merger today.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The CEO, who recently chaired the European summit, announced a major merger today.'</i>
Activity 1.3: Semicolon Resolution of Comma Splices	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Independent clause coordination (<i>Comma Splice Repair</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate comma splices between closely related independent clauses by inserting a semicolon.
Instructions:	Correct the comma splice in the strategic briefing statement.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Market volatility increased sharply in Q3, corporate bond yields fell to historic lows.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Market volatility increased sharply in Q3; corporate bond yields fell to historic lows.'</i>

Activity 1.4: Colon Introductions for Amplification and Lists	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Formal colon placement (<i>Colon Application</i>)
Objective:	Deploy colons following independent clauses to introduce formal lists or explanatory statements.
Instructions:	Insert a colon correctly to introduce an executive summary takeaway.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The board arrived at a single consensus we must liquidate non-performing assets.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The board arrived at a single consensus: we must liquidate non-performing assets.'</i>

Activity 1.5: Emphatic Dashes for Structural Breaks	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Emphatic dash usage (<i>Emphatic Punctuation</i>)
Objective:	Utilize em-dashes to set off abrupt rhetorical breaks or highlight an illustrative summary.
Instructions:	Transform a complex sentence by inserting an em-dash for dramatic emphasis.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The company's primary asset its proprietary AI algorithm was sold during restructuring.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The company's primary asset—its proprietary AI algorithm—was sold during restructuring.'</i>

Activity 1.6: Distinguishing Restrictive vs. Non-Restrictive Relative Clauses	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Comma distinction in relative clauses (<i>Clause Punctuation</i>)
Objective:	Use commas to set off non-restrictive relative clauses while omitting them for restrictive clauses.
Instructions:	Punctuate the sentence according to whether the clause defines or adds non-essential information.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The software updates which were released on Tuesday fixed the security vulnerability.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The software updates, which were released on Tuesday, fixed the security vulnerability.'</i>

Activity 1.7: Punctuation of Conjunctions Joining Independent Clauses	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Coordinating conjunction punctuation (<i>Conjunction Punctuation</i>)
Objective:	Place a comma before a coordinating conjunction (*and*, *but*, *for*, *nor*, *or*, *so*, *yet*) joining independent clauses.
Instructions:	Insert a comma before the coordinating conjunction in a corporate press release.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The audit revealed several minor discrepancies but the financial report was ultimately approved.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The audit revealed several minor discrepancies, but the financial report was ultimately approved.'</i>

Activity 1.8: Avoiding Sentence Fragments in Formal Reports	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Complete clause structure (<i>Fragment Repair</i>)
Objective:	Attach dependent clauses or participial phrases to independent clauses to eliminate sentence fragments.
Instructions:	Repair the sentence fragment in a policy draft.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The board voted to approve the international expansion project. Having reviewed all market risks.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Having reviewed all market risks, the board voted to approve the international expansion project.'</i>

Activity 1.9: Possessive Singular Formations of Proper Nouns	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Possessive apostrophe rules (<i>Possessive Mechanics</i>)
Objective:	Form possessive singular nouns by adding <i>'s</i> regardless of the final consonant sound.
Instructions:	Apply Strunk's possessive singular rule to proper names ending in <i>s</i> .
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We reviewed Charles report and Burns analysis.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We reviewed Charles's report and Burns's analysis.'</i>

Activity 1.10: Formatting Formal Direct Quotations	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Colon and comma quotation mechanics (<i>Quotation Mechanics</i>)
Objective:	Introduce formal direct quotations exceeding one sentence using a colon rather than a comma.
Instructions:	Format an executive quotation in a press announcement.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The Chairperson stated The quarterly results reflect our resilience. We will continue expanding.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The Chairperson stated: "The quarterly results reflect our resilience. We will continue expanding."'</i>

Module 2: Grammatical Agreement, Pronoun Case & Modifier Alignment

Activity 2.1: Subject-Verb Agreement with Intervening Phrases	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Grammatical agreement precision (<i>Agreement Correction</i>)
Objective:	Maintain singular/plural subject-verb agreement when complex prepositional phrases intervene.
Instructions:	Correct agreement errors caused by intervening plural nouns.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The list of international delegates, corporate sponsors, and keynote speakers were published.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The list of international delegates, corporate sponsors, and keynote speakers was published.'</i>

Activity 2.2: Dangling Participial Phrase Repair	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Participial modifier alignment (<i>Modifier Alignment</i>)
Objective:	Ensure initial participial phrases correctly modify the grammatical subject of the main clause.
Instructions:	Revise sentences containing dangling participial modifiers.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Having completed the annual audit, the report was submitted to the board by the accountant.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Having completed the annual audit, the accountant submitted the report to the board.'</i>

Activity 2.3: Who vs. Whom Case Disambiguation in Formal Register	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing/Speaking — Pronoun case precision (<i>Pronoun Case Selection</i>)
Objective:	Deploy *who* as a subjective pronoun and *whom* as an objective pronoun in formal discourse.
Instructions:	Select and correctly position *who* or *whom* in diplomatic correspondence.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The committee must determine who / whom should receive the research grant.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The committee must determine who should receive the research grant.'</i>

Activity 2.4: Misplaced Adverbial Modifier Reordering	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Adverbial modifier placement (<i>Modifier Reordering</i>)
Objective:	Position adverbs such as *only*, *nearly*, and *almost* directly adjacent to the words they modify.
Instructions:	Reorder misplaced adverbs to ensure exact semantic precision.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The executive board only approved three of the ten proposed budget amendments.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The executive board approved only three of the ten proposed budget amendments.'</i>

Activity 2.5: Agreement with Indefinite Compound Pronouns	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Singular indefinite agreement (<i>Antecedent Agreement</i>)
Objective:	Ensure singular verbs and possessive antecedents agree with indefinite pronouns (*each*, *everyone*, *nobody*).
Instructions:	Correct pronoun-antecedent agreement in a corporate memo.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Everyone on the research team must submit their peer evaluations by Friday.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Everyone on the research team must submit his or her [or their, depending on style guide] peer evaluation by Friday.'</i>

Activity 2.6: Pronoun Case Following Comparative Than/As	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Elliptical clause case selection (<i>Comparative Pronoun Case</i>)
Objective:	Determine correct nominative or objective pronoun case in comparative clauses following *than* or *as*.
Instructions:	Select the correct pronoun case based on unexpressed verb completion.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The senior analyst has far more experience in international arbitrage than (he/him).'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The senior analyst has far more experience in international arbitrage than he [has].'</i>

Activity 2.7: Compound Subject Agreement with Neither...Nor / Either...Or	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Correlative conjunction agreement (<i>Correlative Agreement</i>)
Objective:	Align verb agreement with the nearer subject in *neither...nor* and *either...or* constructions.
Instructions:	Adjust verb agreement in correlative subject structures.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Neither the Chief Financial Officer nor the board directors was present at the hearing.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Neither the Chief Financial Officer nor the board directors were present at the hearing.'</i>

Activity 2.8: Possessive Case Before Gerunds	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Gerund noun-modifier mechanics (<i>Gerund Possessive Mechanics</i>)
Objective:	Use possessive nouns or pronouns to modify gerund verbal nouns in formal prose.
Instructions:	Correct objective pronouns incorrectly preceding gerunds.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The committee objected to him making executive decisions without board consultation.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The committee objected to his making executive decisions without board consultation.'</i>

Activity 2.9: Resolving Ambiguous Relative Pronoun Reference	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Pronoun antecedent clarity (<i>Reference Disambiguation</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate ambiguous relative pronoun references (*which*, *this*) that lack a clear noun antecedent.
Instructions:	Rewrite vague relative clause references.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The company lowered prices and increased production, which led to market dominance.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The company lowered prices and increased production; this strategy led to market dominance.'</i>

Activity 2.10: Correcting Misplaced Prepositional Phrases	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Prepositional modifier placement (<i>Preposition Placement</i>)
Objective:	Reposition misplaced prepositional phrases so they clearly modify their intended noun.
Instructions:	Eliminate comical or ambiguous modifier placements in executive summaries.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The manager presented a plan to reduce corporate debt in a leather binder.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'In a leather binder, the manager presented a plan to reduce corporate debt.'</i>

Module 3: Active Voice Transformation & Forceful Verbs

Activity 3.1: Converting Weak Passive Verbs to Active Assertions	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Active voice transformation (<i>Active Voice Conversion</i>)
Objective:	Transform evasive or wordy passive constructions into direct, active assertions.
Instructions:	Rewrite the passive corporate announcement into direct active voice.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'It was decided by the executive committee that employee benefits would be restructured.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The executive committee decided to restructure employee benefits.'</i>

Activity 3.2: Eliminating Unnecessary 'There is' / 'There are' Openings	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Expletive opening removal (<i>Expletive Elimination</i>)
Objective:	Replace weak expletive openings (*there is*, *there are*, *it is*) with action-driven subjects.
Instructions:	Eliminate expletive constructs to make prose forceful.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'There are three factors that contributed to the unexpected drop in Q2 revenues.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Three factors contributed to the unexpected drop in Q2 revenues.'</i>

Activity 3.3: Replacing Nominalizations with Dynamic Action Verbs	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — De-nominalization & verb elevation (<i>Verb Elevation</i>)
Objective:	Convert heavy abstract nouns (nominalizations) back into vibrant, active verbs.
Instructions:	Rephrase the noun-heavy sentence into a direct, verb-driven statement.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The team conducted an investigation into the cause of the system failure.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The team investigated the cause of the system failure.'</i>

Activity 3.4: Retaining Justified Passives for Agent Suppression	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Strategic passive deployment (<i>Rhetorical Voice Selection</i>)
Objective:	Identify contexts where the passive voice is rhetorically appropriate (unknown or insignificant agent).
Instructions:	Determine whether to retain passive voice or convert to active in a legal incident report.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The confidential documents were leaked anonymously to the press overnight.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Retain passive: The focus is strictly on the recipient/action because the agent is unknown.'</i>

Activity 3.5: Upgrading Weak Copular Verbs (*Be*, *Seem*)	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Predicate verb strengthening (<i>Copular Replacement</i>)
Objective:	Replace weak copular verbs (*is*, *seems*, *appears*) with precise, evocative verbs.
Instructions:	Strengthen prose by replacing weak linking verbs.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The new policy was an indication of the board's shift toward sustainability.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The new policy signaled the board's shift toward sustainability.'</i>

Activity 3.6: Active Voice Conversion in Executive Minutes	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Executive summary active voice (<i>Action Item Conversion</i>)
Objective:	Audit and convert passive corporate meeting minutes into crisp action items.
Instructions:	Convert passive meeting notes into active executive action points.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'A resolution was passed by shareholders, and a vote was taken by the board.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Shareholders passed a resolution, and the board took a vote.'</i>

Activity 3.7: Eliminating Auxiliary Stacking (*Would have been able to*)	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Auxiliary verb trimming (<i>Auxiliary Trimming</i>)
Objective:	Trim bloated auxiliary verb chains down to direct action verbs.
Instructions:	Condense heavy modal auxiliary chains.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The team might have been able to achieve the deadline if resources had been provided.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The team could have met the deadline with adequate resources.'</i>

Activity 3.8: Transforming Passive Research Findings into Active Insights	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Academic/scientific voice elevation (<i>Academic Synthesis</i>)
Objective:	Rephrase passive academic literature descriptions into active, authoritative synthesis.
Instructions:	Convert passive research statements into authoritative active prose.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'A correlation between market volatility and inflation was observed by researchers.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Researchers observed a correlation between market volatility and inflation.'</i>

Activity 3.9: Active Transitive Verbs in Headline Editing	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Journalistic active phrasing (<i>Headline Active Rewrite</i>)
Objective:	Edit passive media headlines into punchy, active-voice headlines.
Instructions:	Rewrite the passive press headline using a transitive action verb.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'New Environmental Regulations Passed by Parliament Yesterday'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Parliament Passes New Environmental Regulations'</i>

Activity 3.10: Balancing Agent Emphasis in Policy Writing	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Agent focus alignment (<i>Agent Re-alignment</i>)
Objective:	Reorder passive policy sentences to emphasize the responsible entity at the sentence head.
Instructions:	Re-align sentence agents in municipal policy directives.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Fines will be levied on non-compliant businesses by city inspectors.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'City inspectors will levy fines on non-compliant businesses.'</i>

Module 4: Positive Form, Direct Statements & Evasive Removal

Activity 4.1: Converting Negative Expressions to Positive Assertions	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Positive form conversion (<i>Positive Form Conversion</i>)
Objective:	Express ideas in positive, direct terms rather than evasive negative phrasing.
Instructions:	Convert negative/evasive assertions into positive statements.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The board did not think the proposed acquisition was unwise.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The board considered the proposed acquisition prudent.'</i>
Activity 4.2: Eliminating Double Negatives in Formal Discourse	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Double negative removal (<i>Double Negative Elimination</i>)
Objective:	Identify and eliminate inadvertent or weak double negatives.
Instructions:	Rewrite the sentence eliminating the double negative construction.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'It is not uncommon for startups to not generate revenue in their first year.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Startups frequently generate no revenue in their first year.'</i>
Activity 4.3: Replacing Evasive Hedging with Firm Direct Statements	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Direct executive phrasing (<i>Direct Statement Upgrade</i>)
Objective:	Replace weak, hesitant qualifiers (*not improbable*, *not unnecessary*) with resolute terms.
Instructions:	Strengthen a weak policy statement.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'It is not impossible that the launch date will not be delayed.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The team expects to meet the scheduled launch date.'</i>
Activity 4.4: Converting Negative Conditional Clauses	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Conditional clause simplification (<i>Conditional Simplification</i>)
Objective:	Rephrase negative conditional clauses (*unless...not*) into direct positive conditions.
Instructions:	Simplify a negative legal clause.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Unless the tenant does not pay rent on time, eviction proceedings will not begin.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Eviction proceedings begin only if the tenant fails to pay rent on time.'</i>

Activity 4.5: Transforming Evasive Audit Disclaimers	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Audit report directness (<i>Audit Directness</i>)
Objective:	Rewrite timid audit commentary into transparent, direct assessments.
Instructions:	Rephrase an evasive auditor note into a clear finding.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The inventory count was not found to be entirely free from inaccuracies.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The inventory count contained notable inaccuracies.'</i>
Activity 4.6: Direct Formatting of Negative Commands and Warnings	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Imperative clarity (<i>Imperative Directness</i>)
Objective:	Formulate clear, direct safety instructions using positive imperatives where possible.
Instructions:	Convert negative instructions into clear direct guidelines.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Do not enter the facility without displaying proper security credentials.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Display proper security credentials before entering the facility.'</i>
Activity 4.7: Replacing Negative Auxiliaries with Opposing Antonyms	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Lexical antonym substitution (<i>Antonym Substitution</i>)
Objective:	Substitute *not + verb* constructs with precise antonymous verbs.
Instructions:	Replace negative auxiliary verbs with positive antonyms.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The regional manager did not agree with the proposed restructuring.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The regional manager opposed [or rejected] the proposed restructuring.'</i>
Activity 4.8: Converting Indirect Rejections into Clear Polished Responses	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing/Speaking — Diplomatic directness (<i>Diplomatic Directness</i>)
Objective:	Draft direct, polite rejections in professional correspondence without evasive wordiness.
Instructions:	Rephrase an evasive email rejection into a clear, direct refusal.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We do not feel that we are unable to say that your proposal is without merit.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'While your proposal has merit, we cannot accept it at this time.'</i>

Activity 4.9: Positive Framing in Performance Reviews	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Performance review phrasing (<i>Constructive Framing</i>)
Objective:	Frame constructive feedback positively by stating required behaviors directly.
Instructions:	Rewrite weak negative critique into direct, constructive action goals.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The employee does not reliably complete project deliverables on time.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The employee must improve deadline compliance for project deliverables.'</i>

Activity 4.10: Reframing Legal Prohibitions into Express Mandates	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Statutory directness (<i>Statutory Reframing</i>)
Objective:	Convert negative statutory prohibitions into clear affirmative obligations.
Instructions:	Rewrite a legal prohibition as a direct positive duty.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'No director shall fail to disclose conflicts of interest.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Every director shall promptly disclose all conflicts of interest.'</i>

Module 5: Concrete Language, Specificity & Abstract Pruning

Activity 5.1: Replacing Vague Abstractions with Concrete Factual Detail	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Concrete language substitution (<i>Concrete Language Upgrade</i>)
Objective:	Replace high-level abstract jargon (*unfavorable weather conditions*) with exact, concrete descriptions (*heavy snow and -10°C temperatures*).
Instructions:	Upgrade vague corporate statements with specific factual data.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Operations were impacted due to unfavorable meteorological conditions.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Heavy snowfall and ice halted factory operations for three days.'</i>

Activity 5.2: Pruning Institutional Jargon and Buzzwords	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Jargon removal & plain language (<i>Buzzword Elimination</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate hollow corporate buzzwords (*synergize*, *paradigm shift*, *core competencies*) in favor of plain English.
Instructions:	Prune buzzwords from a corporate press release.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We must leverage our core competencies to synergize cross-functional paradigms.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We must combine our team's key skills to improve collaboration across departments.'</i>

Activity 5.3: Quantifying Vague Intensifiers in Financial Reports	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Quantitative precision (<i>Quantitative Precision</i>)
Objective:	Replace subjective intensifiers (*substantially*, *significantly*, *very much*) with precise figures or bounded ranges.
Instructions:	Substitute vague claims with concrete numerical evidence.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Revenues grew significantly in the final quarter of the fiscal year.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Revenues grew by 14.2% to \$4.8 million in Q4.'</i>
Activity 5.4: Converting Abstract Claims into Grounded Examples	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Exemplification & concreteness (<i>Grounded Exemplification</i>)
Objective:	Support general assertions by attaching immediate, concrete examples.
Instructions:	Add a concrete example to ground an abstract claim.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The company implemented several employee wellness initiatives recently.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The company introduced flexible working hours, subsidized gym memberships, and mental health stipends.'</i>
Activity 5.5: Replacing Vague Pronouns (*It*, *Thing*, *Factor*) with Precise Nouns	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Lexical specificity (<i>Lexical Specificity</i>)
Objective:	Replace vague placeholder nouns (*things*, *factors*, *aspects*) with domain-specific terms.
Instructions:	Identify and replace vague nouns in a technical memo.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Several negative things affected the project's overall progress.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Supply chain delays and software bugs stalled project progress.'</i>
Activity 5.6: De-abstracting Policy Objectives	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Policy document concreteness (<i>Operational Concreteness</i>)
Objective:	Convert abstract corporate mission statements into actionable operational targets.
Instructions:	Rewrite an abstract policy goal into concrete operational instructions.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Our goal is the holistic optimization of customer satisfaction dynamics.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Our goal is to reduce customer support response times to under two minutes.'</i>

Activity 5.7: Pruning Redundant Category Nouns (*In nature*, *In character*)	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Redundant noun pruning (<i>Redundant Noun Removal</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate useless category nouns (*blue in color*, *severe in nature*, *large in size*).
Instructions:	Prune redundant category words from descriptive prose.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The emergency response was rapid in nature and comprehensive in character.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The emergency response was rapid and comprehensive.'</i>

Activity 5.8: Sensory and Physical Detail in Narrative Case Studies	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Descriptive physical precision (<i>Case Study Detail</i>)
Objective:	Incorporate sharp physical and situational detail into executive case studies.
Instructions:	Enrich a sparse case study narrative with concrete details.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The old factory was inefficient and needed modern machinery.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The 1950s foundry relied on rusted coal furnaces that broke down weekly.'</i>

Activity 5.9: Replacing Generic Verbs (*Get*, *Make*, *Do*) with Specific Action Terms	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Specific verb selection (<i>Specific Verb Upgrade</i>)
Objective:	Replace overused general verbs with precise, context-specific action verbs.
Instructions:	Upgrade weak verbs in a project status report.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We got good results when we did the market testing for the product.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We yielded favorable metrics upon conducting pilot market testing for the product.'</i>

Activity 5.10: Pruning Circumlocutions (*At this point in time*)	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Circumlocution trimming (<i>Circumlocution Removal</i>)
Objective:	Replace wordy phrases (*due to the fact that*, *at this point in time*) with single, direct words (*because*, *now*).
Instructions:	Trim circumlocutions in a formal letter.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'At this point in time, we are unable to proceed due to the fact that funds are lacking.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We cannot proceed now because funds are lacking.'</i>

Module 6: Conciseness, Omitting Needless Words & Economy of Style

Activity 6.1: Ruthless Wordiness Pruning in Executive Briefings	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Sentence compression & conciseness (<i>Sentence Compression</i>)
Objective:	Prune bloated sentences by 30–50% without losing core semantic meaning (Strunk's Rule 17).
Instructions:	Compress the verbose passage into a concise, punchy sentence.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'His story was a story of a unique kind of experience that was very remarkable.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'His story was remarkable.'</i>
Activity 6.2: Eliminating Tautologies and Pleonasms	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Tautology elimination (<i>Tautology Removal</i>)
Objective:	Remove redundant word pairings (*null and void*, *future prospects*, *past history*, *end result*).
Instructions:	Eliminate tautological phrasing from a legal contract draft.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The end result of the merger will create future prospects for growth.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The merger will create growth prospects.'</i>
Activity 6.3: Condensing Relative Clauses into Participle Modifiers	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Clause compression (<i>Clause Compression</i>)
Objective:	Compress wordy relative clauses (*which was conducted by*) into concise participial phrases or single adjectives.
Instructions:	Reduce relative clauses to streamline sentence flow.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The report, which was written by the consultant, contained data that was accurate.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The consultant's report contained accurate data.'</i>
Activity 6.4: Trimming Prepositional Stack Drag	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Prepositional phrase reduction (<i>Preposition Reduction</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate chains of prepositional phrases (*of*, *in*, *to*, *for*) by converting to possessives or adjectives.
Instructions:	Reduce a chain of four prepositional phrases down to a tight phrase.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The opinion of the manager of the department of finance was respected.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The finance manager's opinion was respected.'</i>

Activity 6.5: Editing Bloated Press Release Openings	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Press release editing (<i>Preamble Pruning</i>)
Objective:	Trim filler preamble from press release openings to deliver the headline immediately.
Instructions:	Remove filler introductory phrases.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We are writing this press release to inform you that our company has won the award.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Our company won the award.'</i>

Activity 6.6: Condensing Infinitive Phrases of Purpose	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Infinitive phrase compression (<i>Infinitive Compression</i>)
Objective:	Replace wordy purpose expressions (*in order to*, *for the purpose of*) with simple infinitives (*to*).
Instructions:	Trim wordy purpose phrases in an operational manual.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The team gathered for the purpose of reviewing quarterly financial performance.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The team gathered to review quarterly financial performance.'</i>

Activity 6.7: Pruning Parenthetical Padding (*It goes without saying*)	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Filler phrase removal (<i>Padding Removal</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate meaningless parenthetical padding (*needless to say*, *it is interesting to note that*).
Instructions:	Remove meta-discourse padding from an academic draft.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'It goes without saying that thorough research is important for success.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Thorough research is essential for success.'</i>

Activity 6.8: Converting Compound Prepositions into Single Words	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Compound preposition simplification (<i>Preposition Simplification</i>)
Objective:	Replace compound prepositions (*with a view to*, *in connection with*) with simple prepositions (*to*, *about*).
Instructions:	Simplify compound prepositions in formal correspondence.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We are writing in connection with your inquiry regarding financial credit.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We are writing about your credit inquiry.'</i>

Activity 6.9: Executive Summary One-Page Compression Exercise	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Paragraph-level pruning (<i>Paragraph Compression</i>)
Objective:	Edit a 150-word verbose paragraph down to a tight 60-word executive summary.
Instructions:	Prune a bloated corporate summary paragraph to under 60 words.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Owing to the fact that there were numerous unforeseen circumstances of an adverse nature during the last quarter, the financial performance was not as good as expected.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Unforeseen quarter-four adverse circumstances lowered financial performance below expectations.'</i>

Activity 6.10: Removing Reflexive and Self-Evident Qualifiers	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Qualifier removal (<i>Qualifier Removal</i>)
Objective:	Remove self-evident qualifiers (*personally I feel*, *in my opinion*, *actual facts*).
Instructions:	Prune self-evident qualifiers from an editorial draft.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'In my personal opinion, the actual facts of the case speak for themselves.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The facts of the case speak for themselves.'</i>

Module 7: Parallel Structure, Coordinated Ideas & Rhetorical Symmetry

Activity 7.1: Balancing Parallel Structures in Multi-Item Lists	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Parallelism in series (<i>Parallel List Correction</i>)
Objective:	Ensure all items in a series share identical grammatical form (all gerunds, all infinitives, or all noun phrases).
Instructions:	Correct non-parallel list structures in a job description.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Responsibilities include managing budgets, to oversee staff, and client reports.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Responsibilities include managing budgets, overseeing staff, and drafting client reports.'</i>

Activity 7.2: Parallel Alignment with Correlative Conjunctions	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Correlative parallelism (<i>Correlative Alignment</i>)
Objective:	Place parallel elements directly following both parts of correlative conjunctions (*either...or*, *not only...but also*).
Instructions:	Correct asymmetrical correlative placement in a keynote speech script.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The policy not only affects corporate profits but also worker morale.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The policy affects not only corporate profits but also worker morale.'</i>

Activity 7.3: Parallel Structuring in Presentation Bullet Points	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Bullet list parallelism (<i>Bullet Point Alignment</i>)
Objective:	Standardize presentation slide bullet points so each entry begins with the same part of speech.
Instructions:	Align bullet points in an executive presentation deck.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: '• Reduce overhead cost • Improving customer service • Expand into regional markets'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: '• Reduce overhead cost • Improve customer service • Expand regional market reach'</i>

Activity 7.4: Parallelism in Comparative Clauses (*Than*, *As*)	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Comparative parallelism (<i>Comparative Balance</i>)
Objective:	Ensure both sides of a comparative comparison balance grammatically.
Instructions:	Repair unbalanced comparative constructions.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Drafting a comprehensive report is more difficult than to deliver a brief presentation.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Drafting a comprehensive report is more difficult than delivering a brief presentation.'</i>

Activity 7.5: Rhetorical Symmetry in Policy Statements	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Rhetorical parallel construction (<i>Rhetorical Symmetry</i>)
Objective:	Design symmetrical sentences to heighten rhetorical impact in public policy addresses.
Instructions:	Rephrase a clumsy policy assertion into a balanced, parallel sentence.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We seek peace through strength, and building trust will bring security.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We seek peace through strength, and security through trust.'</i>

Activity 7.6: Parallel Structure in Compound Predicates	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Compound predicate parallelism (<i>Predicate Parallelism</i>)
Objective:	Maintain identical verb forms across compound predicates.
Instructions:	Correct compound predicate mismatch in a project proposal.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The consultant analyzed the market data, identified growth targets, and proposes strategic changes.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The consultant analyzed the market data, identified growth targets, and proposed strategic changes.'</i>

Activity 7.7: Aligning Balanced Antithetical Statements	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Antithetical parallelism (<i>Antithetical Balance</i>)
Objective:	Construct balanced antithetical sentences (*not X, but Y*) for persuasive writing.
Instructions:	Frame a clear contrast using antithetical parallel structure.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Our goal is not making short-term profit. We want long-term sustainability.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Our goal is not short-term profit, but long-term sustainability.'</i>
Activity 7.8: Parallel Structure Across Coordinated Independent Clauses	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Clause parallelism (<i>Coordinated Clause Parallelism</i>)
Objective:	Structure coordinated clauses with symmetrical word order for enhanced readability.
Instructions:	Align word order across two coordinated clauses.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The first department handled customer inquiries; technical support was managed by the second.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The first department handled customer inquiries; the second managed technical support.'</i>
Activity 7.9: Correcting Faulty Parallelism in Analytical Summaries	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Editorial parallelism repair (<i>Editorial Parallelism</i>)
Objective:	Audit and repair faulty parallelism in an analytical essay excerpt.
Instructions:	Correct mixed grammatical forms in an essay passage.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The study examined economic growth, how inflation fluctuates, and market stabilization.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The study examined economic growth, inflation fluctuation, and market stabilization.'</i>
Activity 7.10: Rhetorical Anaphora with Parallel Structure	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Anaphoric parallel rhetoric (<i>Anaphoric Parallel Rhetoric</i>)
Objective:	Deploy repeated opening phrases (anaphora) combined with parallel clause structures in persuasive speeches.
Instructions:	Draft a 2-sentence persuasive speech excerpt using anaphora and parallel structure.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Emphasize investment in innovation, workforce training, and infrastructure.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We must invest in our scientific innovation; we must invest in our workforce training; we must invest in our public infrastructure.'</i>

Module 8: Sentence Variety, Loose Sentence Repair & Emphatic Endings

Activity 8.1: Converting Loose Sentences into Periodic Sentences	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Periodic sentence construction (<i>Periodic Transformation</i>)
Objective:	Transform trailing loose sentences (main clause followed by endless dependent modifiers) into suspenseful periodic sentences.
Instructions:	Rewrite a trailing loose sentence so the main point comes at the end.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The proposal was finally approved after months of intense debate, market research, and board reviews.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'After months of intense debate, market research, and board reviews, the proposal was finally approved.'</i>

Activity 8.2: Positioning Emphatic Words at Sentence Termination	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — End-weight & emphatic placement (<i>Emphatic Ending Placement</i>)
Objective:	Reorder sentence elements so the most important word or phrase falls at the sentence conclusion (Strunk's Rule 22).
Instructions:	Shift the key keyword to the emphatic final position.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Profitability is the main objective of this strategy, without a doubt.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Without a doubt, the main objective of this strategy is profitability.'</i>

Activity 8.3: Breaking Up Monotonous Sentence Length Cycles	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Rhetorical sentence rhythm (<i>Rhythmic Variety</i>)
Objective:	Vary sentence lengths across a paragraph to establish rhythmic engagement and prevent monotony.
Instructions:	Combine or split a series of uniform short sentences to create dynamic rhythm.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The market crashed. Stocks plummeted. Investors panicked. The government intervened.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'When the market crashed and stocks plummeted, investors panicked; prompt government intervention soon followed.'</i>

Activity 8.4: Eliminating Monotonous 'Subject-Verb-Object' Trailing Structures	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Syntactic variety (<i>Syntactic Variety</i>)
Objective:	Vary paragraph openings by starting with prepositional phrases, participle clauses, or adverbials rather than plain subjects.
Instructions:	Reorder three consecutive subject-first sentences in a report.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The CEO entered the room. She looked at the report. She addressed the shareholders.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Entering the room, the CEO looked at the report before addressing the shareholders.'</i>
Activity 8.5: End-Weight Placement for Climax and Impact	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Climactic word placement (<i>Climactic Order</i>)
Objective:	Arrange a series of ideas in ascending order of importance, ending with the most significant item.
Instructions:	Reorder a list of consequences to end with the most severe impact.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The breach resulted in bankruptcy, public embarrassment, and minor data losses.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The breach resulted in minor data losses, public embarrassment, and ultimately, bankruptcy.'</i>
Activity 8.6: Transforming Monotonous 'And' / 'So' Compound Sequences	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Coordinating sentence repair (<i>Subordination Upgrade</i>)
Objective:	Replace weak compound sentences joined by *and* or *so* with subordinate clauses.
Instructions:	Subordinate a weak compound sentence.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The research was completed and the team wrote the paper and they submitted it to the journal.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Having completed the research, the team wrote and submitted the paper to the journal.'</i>
Activity 8.7: Utilizing Inversion for Emphatic Endings	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Inverted syntax for emphasis (<i>Inverted Emphasis</i>)
Objective:	Invert standard word order (*Hardly had...*, *Never before...*) to push key concepts into emphatic positions.
Instructions:	Invert a sentence for heightened rhetorical effect.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We have never seen such dedication to research and development.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Never before have we seen such dedication to research and development.'</i>

Activity 8.8: Converting Trailing Relative Clauses to Independent Statements	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Trailing clause repair (<i>Trailing Clause Repair</i>)
Objective:	Detach trailing, weak relative clauses at sentence ends and form sharp independent assertions.
Instructions:	Repair a weak trailing relative clause.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The board passed the new regulation, which was something that surprised many industry observers.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The board passed the new regulation—a move that surprised many industry observers.'</i>

Activity 8.9: Creating Short, Punchy Declarative Conclusion Sentences	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Short declarative emphasis (<i>Declarative Punch</i>)
Objective:	Follow complex background sentences with a short, punchy declarative summary sentence.
Instructions:	Craft a short, forceful concluding sentence for a complex paragraph.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'After evaluating market trends, competitor acquisitions, and consumer sentiment across three continents...'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'After evaluating market trends, competitor acquisitions, and consumer sentiment across three continents, the decision was clear: we must pivot.'</i>

Activity 8.10: Refining Paragraph Cadence and End-Focus	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Paragraph cadence editing (<i>Paragraph Cadence</i>)
Objective:	Audit a paragraph to ensure every sentence ends on a strong, stress-bearing word rather than a weak preposition or qualifier.
Instructions:	Re-align paragraph sentence endings for maximum vocal resonance.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The treaty was signed by both nations after months of debate, in the end.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'After months of debate, both nations finally signed the treaty.'</i>

Module 9: Commonly Misused Words, Distinctions & Precision

Activity 9.1: Disambiguating *That* vs. *Which* in Relative Clauses	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Restrictive relative precision (<i>Restrictive Precision</i>)
Objective:	Deploy *that* for restrictive relative clauses (no commas) and *which* for non-restrictive clauses (with commas).
Instructions:	Select *that* or *which* correctly in formal legal documents.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The contract [that/which] was signed on Monday contains the indemnity clause.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The contract that was signed on Monday contains the indemnity clause.'</i>

Activity 9.2: Disinterested vs. Uninterested Disambiguation	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing/Speaking — Precision in vocabulary (<i>Lexical Boundary Precision</i>)
Objective:	Distinguish between *disinterested* (impartial/unbiased) and *uninterested* (bored/indifferent).
Instructions:	Choose the correct word in an arbitration report.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The judge must remain completely (disinterested / uninterested) in the financial outcome.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The judge must remain completely disinterested in the financial outcome.'</i>

Activity 9.3: Affect vs. Effect Structural Placement	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Verb/noun precision (<i>Affect/Effect Selection</i>)
Objective:	Correctly deploy *affect* as a verb (to influence) and *effect* as a noun (result) or verb (to bring about).
Instructions:	Select *affect* or *effect* in an economic brief.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Inflation will (affect/effect) consumer spending, but the policy's overall (affect/effect) remains uncertain.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Inflation will affect consumer spending, but the policy's overall effect remains uncertain.'</i>

Activity 9.4: Comprise vs. Compose Mechanics	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Part-whole verb mechanics (<i>Comprise/Compose Repair</i>)
Objective:	Apply *compose* (parts make up the whole) and *comprise* (the whole contains the parts; never 'is comprised of').
Instructions:	Correct misuse of *comprise* in organizational descriptions.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The advisory board is comprised of ten international experts.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The advisory board comprises ten international experts. [or: is composed of]'</i>

Activity 9.5: Fewer vs. Less Quantitative Selection	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Countable vs. uncountable quantity (<i>Quantity Selection</i>)
Objective:	Use *fewer* for discrete, countable items and *less* for uncountable quantities/masses.
Instructions:	Correct quantitative modifier errors in market analysis.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'There were less investment opportunities this year, leading to less capital allocation.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'There were fewer investment opportunities this year, leading to less capital allocation.'</i>
Activity 9.6: Eliminating *Utilize* in Favor of *Use*	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Plain language verb replacement (<i>Jargon Elimination</i>)
Objective:	Replace pretentious jargon (*utilize*) with direct, clean verbs (*use*).
Instructions:	Simplify word choices in a technical manual.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The team will utilize new software tools to process client data.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The team will use new software tools to process client data.'</i>
Activity 9.7: Continuous vs. Continual Distinctions	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Temporal modifier precision (<i>Temporal Precision</i>)
Objective:	Distinguish between *continuous* (uninterrupted without pause) and *continual* (occurring repeatedly with gaps).
Instructions:	Select the correct modifier in a technical incident report.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The server suffered (continual/continuous) rain vs. intermittent outages.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The system experienced continual outages throughout the week. [intermittent with pauses]'</i>
Activity 9.8: Like vs. As / As If Grammatical Boundaries	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing/Speaking — Preposition vs. conjunction usage (<i>Conjunction Boundary</i>)
Objective:	Use *like* as a preposition before nouns/pronouns and *as / as if* as conjunctions introducing clauses.
Instructions:	Correct casual use of *like* introducing a clause.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The market reacted like we predicted it would in Q2.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The market reacted as we predicted it would in Q2.'</i>

Activity 9.9: Farther vs. Further Distance Extensions	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Spatial vs. metaphorical extension (<i>Distance Disambiguation</i>)
Objective:	Deploy *farther* for physical distance and *further* for metaphorical extent or additional time/degree.
Instructions:	Choose *farther* or *further* in a strategic planning memo.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We must conduct (farther/further) research before expanding (farther/further) north.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We must conduct further research before expanding farther north.'</i>

Activity 9.10: Alternate vs. Alternative Selection	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Adjective boundary selection (<i>Adjective Selection</i>)
Objective:	Distinguish *alternate* (every second one; substituting by turn) from *alternative* (a different choice).
Instructions:	Correct word choice in an operational contingency plan.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We must develop an (alternate/alternative) strategy in case the primary plan fails.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We must develop an alternative strategy in case the primary plan fails.'</i>

Module 10: Principles of Style, Rhetorical Editing & Executive Polish

Activity 10.1: Applying E. B. White's Rule: 'Place Yourself in the Background'	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Objective stance & self-effacement (<i>Self-Effacement Editing</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate self-referential commentary (*I think*, *in my personal view*) to focus entirely on substance.
Instructions:	Edit an opinionated proposal into an objective, self-effacing assessment.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'In my personal opinion, I believe that our team has created an exceptionally good product.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The team created an exceptional product.'</i>

Activity 10.2: Removing Superfluous Qualifiers (*Very*, *Rather*, *Little*, *Pretty*)	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Qualifier removal & tone sharpening (<i>Qualifier Pruning</i>)
Objective:	Prune weak qualifiers (*very*, *rather*, *little*, *pretty*) that dilute assertion strength (White's Rule 8).
Instructions:	Remove dilute qualifiers from a critical review.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The results were very unique and rather unexpected for a pretty large company.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The results were unique and unexpected for a large company.'</i>

Activity 10.3: Eliminating Overstatement and Exaggeration	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Restraint & accurate framing (<i>Restraint Editing</i>)
Objective:	Replace overstated claims (*revolutionary*, *unprecedented*, *catastrophic*) with measured, defensible claims.
Instructions:	Tone down hyperbolic claims in a corporate press release.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'This revolutionary product will completely transform the world of finance forever.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'This product introduces significant efficiencies to financial asset management.'</i>

Activity 10.4: Avoiding Breezy, Casual Register in Executive Memos	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Formal register maintenance (<i>Register Elevation</i>)
Objective:	Convert casual, breezy idioms into polished, professional executive prose.
Instructions:	Upgrade a colloquial email draft into a formal memorandum.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Hey team, let's touch base on the financial stuff ASAP before things hit the fan.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Please review the financial reports prior to tomorrow's executive board review.'</i>

Activity 10.5: Pruning Awkward Adverbs (*Indubitably*, *Needlessly*)	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Adverbial style pruning (<i>Adverb Pruning</i>)
Objective:	Eliminate heavy, awkward *-ly* adverbs by embedding meaning into strong verbs and nouns.
Instructions:	Replace clunky *-ly* adverbs with strong action verbs.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The CEO decisively and authoritatively rejected the proposal completely.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'The CEO rejected the proposal.'</i>

Activity 10.6: Avoiding Fancy Words for Simple Concepts	C1 Advanced
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Plain language vocabulary (<i>Plain Language Upgrade</i>)
Objective:	Substitute pretentious terms (*cognizant*, *equitable*, *prior to*) with plain equivalents (*aware*, *fair*, *before*).
Instructions:	Simplify over-engineered vocabulary in a policy document.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'Be cognizant that prior to commencement, an equitable distribution must occur.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Be aware that before starting, a fair distribution must occur.'</i>

Activity 10.7: Clarity First: Auditing Ambiguous Sentence Constructions	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Clarity audit & restructuring (<i>Clarity Audit</i>)
Objective:	Restructure confusing, multi-clause sentences to ensure immediate, unambiguous comprehension.
Instructions:	Audit and rewrite a confusing legal clause for instant clarity.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'The failure of the system to operate correctly was due to the lack of maintenance by staff who were untrained.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'System failure occurred because untrained staff neglected routine maintenance.'</i>

Activity 10.8: Eliminating Foreign Concepts and Unnecessary Foreign Words	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Native English idiom selection (<i>Idiom Naturalization</i>)
Objective:	Replace unnecessary foreign terms (*raison d'être*, *vis-à-vis*, *zeitgeist*) with precise English equivalents.
Instructions:	Substitute foreign terms with plain, precise English words.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'We must analyze our performance vis-à-vis our competitor's raison d'être.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'We must analyze our performance compared to our competitor's core purpose.'</i>

Activity 10.9: Full Executive Summary Editorial Audit	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing — Comprehensive style & mechanics audit (<i>Comprehensive Audit</i>)
Objective:	Perform a comprehensive editorial audit on a 100-word draft, applying all Strunk & White principles.
Instructions:	Edit a draft for active voice, conciseness, concrete detail, and parallel structure.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'There are many reasons why it is believed that the company suffered losses. It was felt by management that bad weather and poorly trained staff were the main things.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'Management attributed the company's severe quarterly losses to bad weather and untrained staff.'</i>

Activity 10.10: Authoritative Final Polish of a Keynote Address	C2 Mastery
Skill / Subskill:	Writing/Speaking — Keynote style refinement (<i>Keynote Polish</i>)
Objective:	Polishing a keynote speech draft for cadenced parallelism, strong end-focus, and zero fluff.
Instructions:	Refine a closing keynote paragraph into an authoritative speech finale.
Task Prompt:	Prompt: 'In conclusion, I want to say that we should very much strive to make progress in innovation and being sustainable.'
Expected Output:	<i>Output: 'To lead the market, we must innovate with courage and build with sustainability.'</i>